

November

17

2020

Whale discovery

While searching for a hard-to-find whale species deep in the waters off the coast of Mexico, unexpected clicking noises led researchers to discover another previously unknown beaked species of whale.



Born this day

1944 Danny DeVito, US screenwriter, actor, and director. He has starred in films such as *Matilda* and *Batman Returns*.

1960 RuPaul Charles, Black American drag queen and television star. He presents the globally successful TV show *RuPaul's Drag Race*.

1869

Suez Canal

The 193 km (120 mile) long Suez Canal in Egypt officially opened in front of spectators, with feasts and firework displays. The waterway allows ships to pass between the Mediterranean and Red seas.

1970

Computer mouse

US inventor Douglas Engelbart received a patent for his computer mouse. The handheld device made it possible for a computer user to guide a pointer to different places on a screen.



Also on this day

1989 The Velvet Revolution began when students in Prague, Czechoslovakia (present-day Czechia), gathered to protest against the communist government.

2003 Former bodybuilder and actor Arnold Schwarzenegger became governor of California, USA.

2011 Australian scientists found sunken sections of an ancient supercontinent called Gondwana in the Indian Ocean.

